PARTICIPANT WORKSHEET

ChatGPT for Small Business

Your First Hour

Use this sheet during the workshop and keep it as your reference. Write on it, scribble on it, take it home.

Welcome! Here's how today works

You'll try ChatGPT on a real task from your own business, make the result better, and learn how to check it before anyone else sees it. No experience needed. There are no wrong messages: if an answer doesn't help, you just ask again.

A good request has four parts

1 · Who & context

Who you are and about your business. "*I run a small bakery in a busy neighborhood.*"

2 · Task

What you want it to make. "*Write a short Instagram caption for our new pumpkin bread.*"

3 · Details

Facts it must include. "*Baked fresh daily, usually gone by noon.*"

4 · Format & tone

Length, style, layout. "*Under 40 words, friendly, one emoji.*"

The postcard rule

If you wouldn't write it on a postcard, don't paste it. Leave out customer names, phone numbers, emails, addresses, payment or bank details, passwords, and health or other sensitive personal details. Use placeholders like **[CUSTOMER]** or **[ORDER DATE]** and fill in the real details yourself after checking the draft.

Practice 1 · Your first real request (5 minutes)

Pick one task you need to do this week. Fill in the four parts, then type them into ChatGPT as one message.

1 · Who & context

2 · Task

3 · Details it must include

4 · Format & tone

Stuck? Borrow a starter request

Replace the words in [brackets] with your own details.

Customer email

I own a [type of business]. Write a short, friendly email to a customer explaining that [what happened]. Offer [what you can offer]. Keep it under 100 words.

Product or service description

I sell [product] to [type of customer]. Write a 3-sentence description for my website. Mention [two key details]. Warm, plain language.

Sign or notice

Write a clear, friendly sign for my [shop / office] explaining [new policy or change]. Large-print style, 2–3 short lines.

Ideas

I run a [business] in [kind of neighborhood]. Give me 10 low-cost ideas to bring in new customers in [month]. One line each.

Practice 2 · Make it yours with follow-ups (6 minutes)

Stay in the same chat. Send at least two follow-up messages. Tick the ones you tried.

- [ ] **Shorten:** "Make it half as long."
- [ ] **Adjust tone:** "Warmer, less salesy. Sound like a neighbor, not an ad."
- [ ] **Add what's missing:** "Add that we're closed Mondays and take card or cash."
- [ ] **Get options:** "Give me 3 versions. Make one playful."
- [ ] **Stretch:** "What might a customer misunderstand in this? Fix it."

What changed after your follow-ups? What's still not right?

Spot the problem

During the demo, your facilitator will show a draft with a mistake in it. What did you notice?

Remember

ChatGPT only knows what you tell it about your business. When it doesn't know something, it may guess, and guesses can sound very confident. Give it the real facts, or delete the guess.

MINI JAM · 15 MINUTES · IN PAIRS

Pick one challenge

One person types; the other is the **editor** who checks. Swap roles if you try a second challenge.

0–3 min · Pick & plan	3–10 min · Ask, then improve with follow-ups	10–13 · Check	13–15 · Score

A Reply to a tricky customer

A customer emailed that their order arrived late and they're upset. Draft a calm reply that apologizes, explains next steps, and keeps them coming back. Use [CUSTOMER] instead of a real name.

Done looks like: under 120 words · a genuine apology · one clear next step · no promise you haven't approved.

B Plan a week of social posts

Create a 5-post plan for next week: day, goal, caption draft and a photo idea for each. Tell ChatGPT about your real schedule, products and customers.

Done looks like: a 5-row table · each post has a different goal · captions sound like you · every fact (dates, prices, hours) is correct.

C Learn from your reviews

Paste 5–10 of your reviews **with reviewer names removed**, or use the sample reviews below. Ask for the top 3 things customers love, the top 2 complaints, and one change to try.

Done looks like: every theme is backed by at least one real review · no invented quotes · one practical change you could make this month.

Sample reviews (fictional neighborhood café)

> ★★★★★ Best cinnamon rolls in town and the staff remembers my order.

> ★★☆☆☆ Waited 20 minutes for a latte on Saturday. Coffee was great, line was not.

> ★★★★☆ Cozy spot to work. Wish there were more outlets.

> ★★★★★ Friendly owner, fair prices, and the soup changes every day.

> ★★★☆☆ Good food, but they ran out of pastries by 11.

> ★★★★★ Love the gluten-free options. Please keep the lemon bars!

Finished early? Stretch goals

- Ask ChatGPT to turn your result into a reusable request a staff member could use next time.
- Ask it what questions a customer might still have, and answer them in the draft.

MINI JAM · SCORE YOUR WORK

Scoring rubric: 12 points possible

Criterion	1 · Getting started	2 · Solid	3 · Ready to use	Score
Clear request	Task only, little context	Task plus some context	All four parts: context, task, details, format	
Improved draft	Used the first answer as-is	One useful follow-up	Two or more follow-ups that clearly improved it	
Checked & safe	Not checked	Facts checked	Full checklist below done; no private data shared	
Business-ready	Needs a rewrite	Needs small edits	You'd use it this week	
Total	10–12 Jam champion · 7–9 Strong start · 4–6 Great first try: pick one row to improve			

Check it before you send it

Keep this checklist. Use it every time AI helps you write something a customer, employee or partner will see.

Facts

- [ ] Names, dates, prices, hours and policies match my own records
- [ ] Nothing was made up to fill a gap I didn't explain
- [ ] Rules, taxes, permits or legal points confirmed with an official source or a professional

Promises

- [ ] No discount, refund, guarantee or deadline I didn't approve

Fit & tone

- [ ] I read it aloud and it sounds like me
- [ ] It's the right length for where it's going

Fairness & privacy

- [ ] It's respectful; no assumptions about people
- [ ] I'd be comfortable if it went public
- [ ] No private customer or employee details were pasted in
- [ ] Placeholders like [CUSTOMER] are replaced with real details

My next 7 days

Day 1	The real task I'll finish, check and use:
Day 3	Something I dread that I'll try it on:
Day 7	My best request to save and reuse:

Features, plans and settings change over time. For current details, see the official ChatGPT help center.